AIIMS Patna Sarthi — Phase 2: Biotech Plan

Turning a digital-health app into a biotech-eligible product

Phase 1 (today): HIS / digital-health software — live, 136 screens | Phase 2 (this plan): consumable + point-of-care, so the project fits BIRAC / DST biotech schemes

Why Phase 2 is needed

Phase 1 is a software product. Software alone is **not a biotech product**, so it does not fit biotech funding (e.g. BIRAC BIG) on its own. To become biotech-eligible, the project needs a **physical diagnostic or consumable component** — something made, tested and validated, not only coded.

The chosen Phase 2 product

A. QR-labelled sample tracking system (biotech consumable + software)

- Every sample tube carries a printed QR label
- The app shows live status: collected → reached lab → in queue → report ready
- Patient sees “your sample is in the lab, 3rd in queue”
- This is the software half we already have, plus a physical consumable

B. Point-of-care rapid test (optional, later)

- A rapid test for common Patna needs (e.g. dengue / typhoid / UTI)
- Sold through the app’s test screen, result linked to the patient record
- **Not built by us at first** — manufactured by a licensed IVD partner under their licence

The regulatory truth (this is the part usually left out)

IVD kits and reagents are regulated medical devices

- Making an IVD kit needs a **manufacturing licence under MDR-2017**, a functional facility, **ISO 13485** quality system, performance evaluation and (for Class A/B) a notified-body audit.
- This is not a small add-on. It is **a real regulated manufacturing business** — typically 12–24 months and significant cost before the first kit can be sold.
- The risk class (A / B / C / D) is **confirmed by CDSCO** based on intended use — it cannot be assumed from a list. Any class quoted to us must be verified in writing.
- Claims such as “detects a fake drug” or “confirms blood group in 2 minutes” need **validated performance data** before they can be printed anywhere.
- We will not manufacture, label or claim anything until the licence route is clear.

Roadmap

Step 1 · 0–3 months
QR label + live sample tracking pilot inside AIIMS. Software only — no device licence needed for the tracking layer.

Step 2 · 3–9 months
Consumable made by a licensed partner (co-branded). We do not build a plant.

Step 3 · 9–18 months
Point-of-care rapid test under the partner’s licence, with validated performance data.

Step 4 · parallel
BIRAC BIG / DST application with incubation Letter of Intent and a registered company.

What we will not do

- We will not claim to diagnose, prescribe, monitor or predict any disease through the app.
- We will not print performance claims on any kit without validated data.
- We will not present Phase 1 software as a biotech product.

What we ask for

- An **incubation Letter of Intent** (required for BIRAC BIG).
- Written guidance on the **correct IVD class** for a blood-group / rapid-test kit.
- An introduction to a **licensed IVD manufacturing partner** in Bihar or nearby.

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